

# Hosting & Maintaining the Resident Reference Dashboard

A step-by-step guide — no coding required

Prepared for **Dr. Rachel Brancamp**, Associate Director, Transfusion Medicine.

Goal: put the dashboard on **your own** GitHub, publish it as a live link for residents, and update it going forward by simply **describing changes in plain English** to Claude Code. Everything below is done in a web browser.

The dashboard is a **self-contained website** (a set of files). GitHub stores those files for free and publishes them as a live web page (a feature called **GitHub Pages**). You will do three things, once: **(A)** copy the files to your GitHub, **(B)** publish them, and **(C)** connect Claude Code so you can maintain it anytime. Plan about **30 minutes** for the one-time setup.

## What you'll have at the end

- Your own free **GitHub** account with your own copy of the dashboard.
- A live link — <https://YOUR-NAME.github.io/...> — to share with residents.
- **Claude Code** connected to it, so you can update content by typing a request in plain English.
- Full independence — it runs under your account and does not depend on anyone else.

## Before you begin — a quick checklist

- A computer with a web browser (Mac or Windows). Nothing to install.
- A **GitHub** account — free (created in Part A).
- A **Claude Pro** subscription — about **\$20/month**, which includes Claude Code (set up in Part B). GitHub and hosting are free.
- The source dashboard link: <https://github.com/omarzbaba/transfusion-medicine-resident-reference>

## Part A · Put the dashboard on your GitHub one-time

### A1. Create a free GitHub account

- 1 Go to [github.com](https://github.com) and click **Sign up**.

- 2 Enter **your** email, a password, and a **username**. *(The username becomes part of your web address — pick something clean, e.g. `brancamp-tm` or `hfpath`.)*
- 3 Verify your email. Done. *(Already have an account? Skip to A2.)*

## A2. Make your own copy ("Fork")

- 1 Signed in to GitHub, open the source project:  
<https://github.com/omarzbaba/transfusion-medicine-resident-reference>
- 2 Click the **Fork** button (top-right), then **Create fork**.
- 3 GitHub copies everything into **your** account. This copy is yours and independent.

### Even simpler alternative

Omar can add you as a **collaborator** or **transfer** the repository to you directly — then it is already in your account and you can skip the fork. Either way works.

## A3. Turn on the free live website (GitHub Pages)

- 1 In **your** copy of the repository, click the **Settings** tab.
- 2 In the left menu, click **Pages**.
- 3 Under **Source**, choose **Deploy from a branch**; set branch to **main** and folder to **/ (root)**; click **Save**.
- 4 Wait ~1 minute and refresh. Your live link appears at the top: <https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/transfusion-medicine-resident-reference/>

## A4. Share it

Send residents that link. It works on any browser or phone, with no login. That's the hosting done — now let's make it easy to *maintain*.

## Part B · Connect Claude Code one-time · ~10 min

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Claude Code lets you change the dashboard by describing what you want — it edits the files and saves them back to GitHub for you. The easiest version runs **in your browser** (nothing to install).

### B1. Get a Claude subscription

- 1 Go to [claude.com/pricing](https://claude.com/pricing) and choose **Claude Pro** (~\$20/month — plenty for maintaining this dashboard).
- 2 Sign up with **your** email and complete payment.

### B2. Open Claude Code

- 1 Go to [claude.ai/code](https://claude.ai/code) and sign in with your Claude account.
- 2 *Prefer an installed app? You can instead download the **Claude Code desktop app** from the same page — the steps below are identical once you're signed in.*

### B3. Connect your GitHub

- 1 On [claude.ai/code](https://claude.ai/code) you'll see "**Connect GitHub.**" Click it.
- 2 Click **Install Claude GitHub App**. You're taken to GitHub.
- 3 Choose which repositories Claude may access — select your **transfusion-medicine-resident-reference** repo (or "all repositories"), then click **Install** to authorize.

#### What you just allowed

You gave Claude permission to **read** your repository and to **write** changes (as new branches / pull requests) — nothing more. It cannot touch your computer, and it cannot delete your repository. You can revoke access anytime in GitHub → Settings → Applications.

### B4. Create your workspace

- 1 When prompted to "**Create your environment,**" give it a name (e.g., *TM Dashboard*).
- 2 Leave the other options at their defaults and click **Create environment**.

That's the whole setup. From now on you just open [claude.ai/code](https://claude.ai/code) and go.

## Part C · Update the dashboard, anytime

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This is what you'll actually do day-to-day. No coding — you describe the change in plain English.

- 1 Go to [claude.ai/code](https://claude.ai/code) and select your **TM Dashboard** repository.

- 2 In the message box, **type what you want changed** (see examples below) and press Enter.
- 3 Claude reads the files, makes the change, and shows you a **before/after preview**. Approve with ✓ **Accept** (or click **Explain first** to see what it will do).
- 4 Click **Create PR** (pull request) to save the change to GitHub.
- 5 On GitHub, open the pull request, review the highlighted changes, and click **Merge**.
- 6 Your live site updates automatically in **1–2 minutes**. Refresh to see it.

#### Example requests — tailored to this dashboard

You: In the Platelet requests tool, change the prophylactic threshold guidance from "under 10" to "under 20."

You: Update the MSBOS: change the crossmatch units for "Craniotomy" to 4, and add a new procedure "Robotic prostatectomy — Type & Screen."

You: Add three new quiz questions about telling TACO apart from TRALI, with explanations.

You: Update the ASFA entry for "Thrombotic thrombocytopenic purpura" to reflect the latest edition.

You: Change the welcome text on the Start Here page, and add our blood bank pager number to the footer.

You: Show me how the platelet tool decides "appropriate" vs "not indicated" before I change anything.

#### Where the content lives (in case you're curious)

The dashboard has **two pages**, switched by the **Education | Tools** tabs at the top:

| FILE                        | WHAT IT HOLDS                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| index.html                  | <b>Education page</b> — the three pillars, cases, quiz questions, glossary, and recap wording.                                |
| tools.html                  | <b>Tools page</b> — the on-call calculators and reference tools (headings and intro text).                                    |
| assets/reference/refdata.js | <b>The clinical reference data</b> — MSBOS surgery list, ASFA table, platelet & transfusion-reaction rules, reaction catalog. |

|                                                                                                                |                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>assets/reference/abo.data.js</code>                                                                      | ABO donor prevalences used by the blood-prep donor-pool math.                      |
| <code>assets/reference/calculators.js</code>                                                                   | PLASMIC score criteria/bands and the blood & plasma volume formulas.               |
| <code>assets/app.css</code>                                                                                    | The look of <i>both</i> pages — colours, spacing, type. One place to restyle.      |
| <code>assets/updates.js</code>                                                                                 | <b>Version number + release notes.</b> See "Telling residents what changed" below. |
| <code>assets/shell.js</code> · <code>education.js</code> · <code>guide.js</code> · <code>reference/*.js</code> | Behaviour and screens — usually no need to touch these.                            |

## Telling residents what changed

The dashboard greets a first-time visitor with a short welcome guide, and shows returning users a **"What's new"** pop-up whenever the version changes. Both are driven by one small file, `assets/updates.js`. After you make a change:

- 1 Open `assets/updates.js` and add a new block at the **top** of the list, with a version number (e.g. `"1.3.0"`), the month, a short title, and a few plain-English bullet points.
- 2 Change `version:` at the top of the file to that same new number.
- 3 Commit. Anyone who used the older version sees your notes next time they open it; nobody is asked twice.

### Easiest way

Just tell Claude Code: *"I changed X — add a release note for version 1.3.0 and bump the version."* It will edit `updates.js` for you.

You don't need to open these yourself — just tell Claude what you want and it will find the right place. But it helps to know the `refdata.js` and `abo.data.js` files are the *clinical knowledge*.

### ⚠ Clinical & safety notes

- **Review clinical changes with the blood bank** before residents rely on them — the MSBOS is your institutional policy (HFHS [PCR-PALM-TRM-5.050](#) ); ASFA follows the 9th ed. (2023).
- Every change waits for your **approval** and goes to a **separate branch** first — nothing changes the live site until *you* merge. You can always revert.
- Do **not** paste passwords or any patient information into Claude.
- The tool is **for internal use only** and is educational clinical decision **support**, not a substitute for clinical judgment — the treating physician / blood-bank medical director remains the final decision-maker. It holds **no patient data**. This is stated in the footer of both pages.

## Cost & troubleshooting

| ITEM                                  | COST          |
|---------------------------------------|---------------|
| GitHub account + GitHub Pages hosting | Free          |
| Claude Pro (includes Claude Code)     | ~\$20 / month |
| Custom web address (optional)         | \$0–15 / year |

| IF THIS HAPPENS...                     | DO THIS                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Live link shows <b>404 / not found</b> | Wait 1–2 min after enabling Pages; confirm Settings → Pages → Source is <b>main / root</b> ; the main file must be named exactly <code>index.html</code> .                    |
| A reference <b>tab</b> is <b>blank</b> | The <code>assets</code> folder didn't copy. In a fork this won't happen; if you uploaded manually, re-upload including the whole <code>assets</code> folder.                  |
| A <b>change isn't showing</b>          | Give Pages ~2 min, then hard-refresh: <b>Cmd/Ctrl + Shift + R</b> .                                                                                                           |
| Claude shows <b>no repositories</b>    | GitHub → Settings → Applications → Claude → <b>Configure</b> , and make sure your repo is listed under "Repository access."                                                   |
| A change <b>looks wrong</b>            | Don't merge it. Go back to <a href="#">claude.ai/code</a> and say what should be different — or, if already merged, open the pull request on GitHub and click <b>Revert</b> . |

## Quick reference — your typical update

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- 1 Open **claude.ai/code** → pick your dashboard repo.
- 2 Type the change you want, in plain English → Enter.
- 3 Review the preview → ✓ **Accept** → **Create PR**.
- 4 On GitHub, review and **Merge**.
- 5 Live site updates in 1–2 minutes. Done.

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**Transfusion Medicine & Blood Bank — Resident Reference.** Henry Ford Pathology Residency.

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For quick text edits you can also skip Claude Code entirely and edit a file directly on GitHub (open the file → pencil icon → Commit).  
Claude Code shines for larger or clinical-content changes.